



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Cheetah!

Vulnerable

Facts • Colour • Activities

Cheetah Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Acinonyx jubatus
Status:	Vulnerable
Where they live:	Sub-Saharan Africa; small population in Iran
Habitat:	Open grasslands and bushy areas in parts of Africa and the Middle East
Diet:	Carnivore — gazelles, impalas, wildebeest calves, hares
Weight:	21–65 kg
Lifespan:	10–12 years in the wild
Population:	Fewer than 7,100 in the wild

Amazing Facts ■

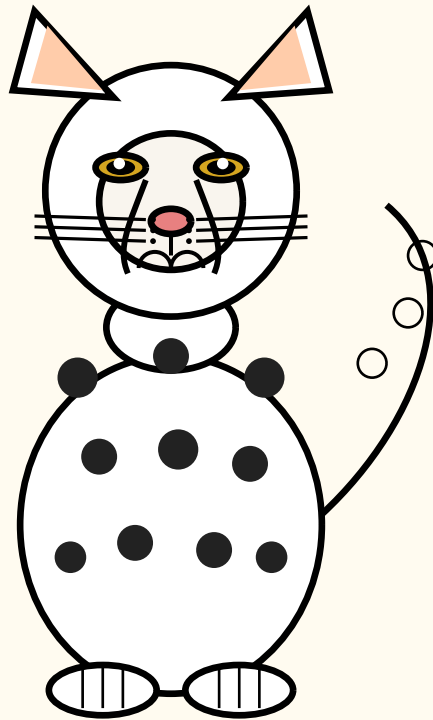
- The cheetah is the fastest land animal, reaching 97–113 km/h (60–70 mph) over short distances.
- Unlike other big cats, cheetahs cannot roar — but they purr, chirp, and even bark!
- A cheetah's spots are solid black dots; a leopard's are hollow rosette shapes.
- Bold black 'tear stripes' run from inner eye corners to the mouth, reducing sun glare.
- After a chase, a cheetah must rest about 30 minutes to cool down before it can eat.
- Cheetah mums have 4–6 cubs and spend 18 months teaching them to hunt.

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Habitat loss as grasslands are converted to farmland	CRITICAL
2	Conflict with farmers protecting livestock	HIGH
3	Illegal wildlife trade — cubs taken as exotic pets	HIGH
4	Prey depletion from overhunting	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Cheetah

Cheetahs are tawny yellow with solid black spots. Their underside is white; two solid black 'tear stripes' run from eye to mouth.



Activities ➡

Word Search — find all 8 words!

X	U	E	G	R	A	S	S	L	A	N	D
Q	P	X	C	F	S	D	H	Q	A	R	V
K	Q	P	V	A	N	N	I	M	C	F	D
P	H	C	G	S	Z	O	I	E	U	E	X
J	P	H	C	T	E	K	Q	R	R	J	F
B	R	E	O	E	K	G	O	E	S	G	S
V	E	E	Z	S	A	T	G	T	N	M	L
L	Y	T	F	T	A	N	O	I	I	D	S
H	Q	A	K	D	A	P	T	J	B	B	M
L	M	H	E	D	S	N	U	K	P	A	Z
C	V	R	N	E	U	W	K	Q	D	E	C
U	P	E	F	H	A	F	R	I	C	A	N

CHEETAH	GRASSLAND	PREDATOR	ENDANGERED
AFRICA	FASTEST	SPOTS	HUNTING

Match It Up!

Cheetah		a cheetah's favourite prey
Grassland		work to protect wildlife
Gazelle		the cheetah's habitat
Tear stripes		fastest land animal
Conservation		black lines under the eyes

Fill in the Blanks!

- The cheetah can reach _____ km/h over short distances.
- Cheetahs have solid black _____ on their fur.
- Unlike other big cats, cheetahs cannot _____.
- Cheetahs are found mainly in _____ Africa.

Answers: 113 | spots | roar | Sub-Saharan

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